1. Thong Chai: the essentials

Singapore Thong Chai Medical Institution 新加坡同济医院 | Notes from the supplied slide photographs and partial transcript

Main takeaway: The visit presented TCM (中医) as an individualised system of assessment and treatment (辨证论治), delivered here through a charitable institution committed to accessible care.

Institution and community role

Key point	What the speaker reported
History	Established in **1867**, with more than 150 years of history.
Founding principle	Free medical consultation and TCM treatment for the public, regardless of **race, religion or nationality**.
Mission and vision	Promote TCM, provide free consultation, treat people equally and give back to the community; aspire to be a leading charitable TCM provider in the region.
Scale of service	More than **1,300 patients daily** across its clinics, according to the briefing. This is a visit-time statement, not an independently checked current statistic.
Clinic network	The speaker mentioned a main institution and four community clinics. Place names in the automated transcript are unclear and are not reproduced here as confirmed facts.

What the session covered

Assessment: the four diagnostic methods (四诊) - inspection (望诊); listening and smelling (闻诊); inquiry (问诊); and palpation (切诊). Tongue inspection and pulse taking were the main demonstrations.

Medicines: how Chinese medicinal materials are classified, and examples including Danggui, Huangqi, Duzhong, Meiguihua and Chantui.

Treatments: acupuncture sensations, selected acupoints and cupping methods. These later topics are documented mainly by photographs.

Central principle: individualised treatment

At about **34:20-35:20**, the speaker explained that people with the same disease may show different symptoms and receive different treatments. The key idea is to assess the individual pattern rather than assume that one diagnosis always leads to one prescription.

Sources: transcribe.txt, main recording 00:00-02:48 and 34:20-35:47. The second transcript file is an identical copy.

2. Tongue diagnosis 舌诊

Observe the tongue body and its coating together.

The speaker described a normal tongue as **light red with a thin white coating (薄白苔)**. The tongue body (舌质) is assessed for colour, shape, size and movement; the coating (舌苔) for colour, thickness, moisture and greasiness.

Patterns shown in the teaching slides

TCM pattern label	Appearance shown
Blood deficiency 血虚	Pale tongue; little or no coating.
Heat 热证	Red tongue; thin yellow coating.
Damp retention 湿阻	Swollen tongue; white greasy coating.
Qi stagnation 气滞	Red tongue tip.
Blood stasis 血瘀	Purple tongue; dark spots.
Damp heat 湿热	Red tongue; greasy yellow coating.
Yin deficiency 阴虚	Red tongue with cracks; little or no coating.
Qi deficiency 气虚	Pale tongue with red spots and thin white coating. The separate common-types slide also shows teeth marks.
Yang deficiency 阳虚	Pale, swollen tongue; thin white coating and teeth marks.

How the lecturer explained the observations

Colour: paleness was linked to qi/blood deficiency, redness to heat, and purple colour to blood stagnation within TCM theory.

Shape: swelling was associated with retained fluids or dampness; a thin tongue with deficiency; teeth marks with spleen-qi deficiency and dampness.

Coating: yellowing was associated with heat, greasiness with dampness, and moisture or dryness with the condition of body fluids.

What to remember for the report

These are **TCM pattern descriptions** presented during teaching. They are not evidence that a tongue photograph alone can establish a medical diagnosis. The materials support describing how practitioners interpret signs; they do not establish the accuracy of those interpretations.

Sources: Photos ending 23-47-36, 23-47-37 and 23-47-38; transcribe.txt 02:49-07:05. The first two photographs show the same slide.

2A. Tongue: photo reference

A photographed teaching chart, placed beside the tongue diagnosis notes.

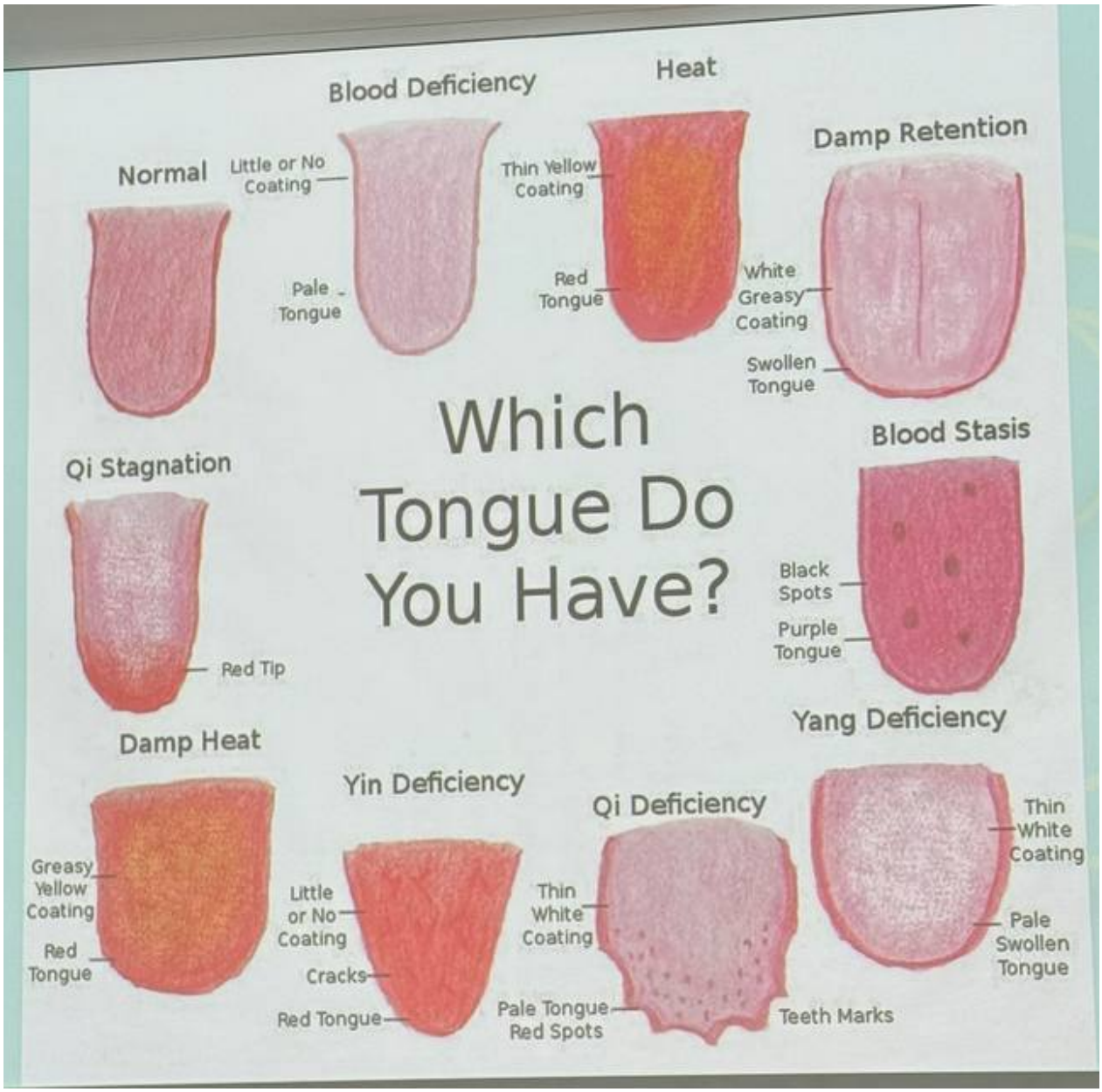


Figure 1. Tongue patterns 舌象**.** Compare the tongue body (舌质), coating (舌苔), colour and shape. The chart illustrates the TCM labels summarised in Section 2.

Useful visual features

Pale tongue 淡白舌**:** shown under deficiency patterns. **Purple tongue** 紫舌**:** shown under blood stasis. **Yellow greasy coating** 黄腻苔**:** shown under damp heat.

Sources: Cropped from photo_2026-10-15_23-47-38.jpg. Original teaching labels retained; use with the explanation and limitations in Section 2.

3. Pulse diagnosis 脉诊

Assess position, depth, speed, rhythm, strength and texture.

Pulse taking was demonstrated over the **radial artery at the wrist**. Three fingers assess **cun 寸, guan 关 and chi 尺**; the slide uses the radial styloid as the landmark for guan. Pressure progresses from superficial (浮) to middle (中) to deep (沉).

Position	Left wrist: slide correspondence	Right wrist: slide correspondence
Cun 寸	Heart 心	Lung 肺
Guan 关	Liver / gallbladder 肝胆	Spleen / stomach 脾胃
Chi 尺	Kidney 肾	Kidney / life gate 肾 / 命门

These are correspondences within TCM theory. The speaker described a normal pulse as regular, neither excessively strong nor weak, with about **4-5 beats per complete breath**.

Pulse type	Description and teaching association
Superficial 浮脉	Felt with light pressure, weaker with heavy pressure; linked to exterior patterns such as cold/flu presentations.
Deep 沉脉	Requires heavier pressure; linked to interior patterns. The depth slide distinguishes forceful/excess from weak/deficiency.
Rapid 数脉	Slide: more than 5 beats per breath, above 90/min; linked to heat patterns.
Moderate 缓脉	Slide: relaxed and forceful, about 60-70/min; may be healthy or associated with dampness or insufficient qi/blood.
Excess 实脉	Strong at all three positions; associated with excess patterns, but also possible in healthy people.
Thin 细脉	Fine like a thread but still palpable; linked to qi/blood deficiency, with yin deficiency also on the strength slide.
Wiry 弦脉	Tense like a violin string; linked to stress, anger, pain and liver/gallbladder patterns.
Slippery 滑脉	Smooth, like beads rolling on a plate; linked to phlegm/fluid or food retention and heat; also shown for pregnancy and healthy adults.

Context matters: the slides list exercise, stress/anger, a heavy meal, age, athletic conditioning, body build and sex-related generalisations as influences. The clearest stress-related statement is **“Stress/anger: more wiry.”** These teaching ranges are not general medical screening cut-offs.

Sources: Photos ending 23-47-39 through 23-47-47; transcribe.txt 12:55-22:48. The transcript also mentions an intermittent pulse, but its explanation is too unclear to summarise reliably.

3A. Pulse: photo reference

The wrist positions and pressure levels used in the demonstration.

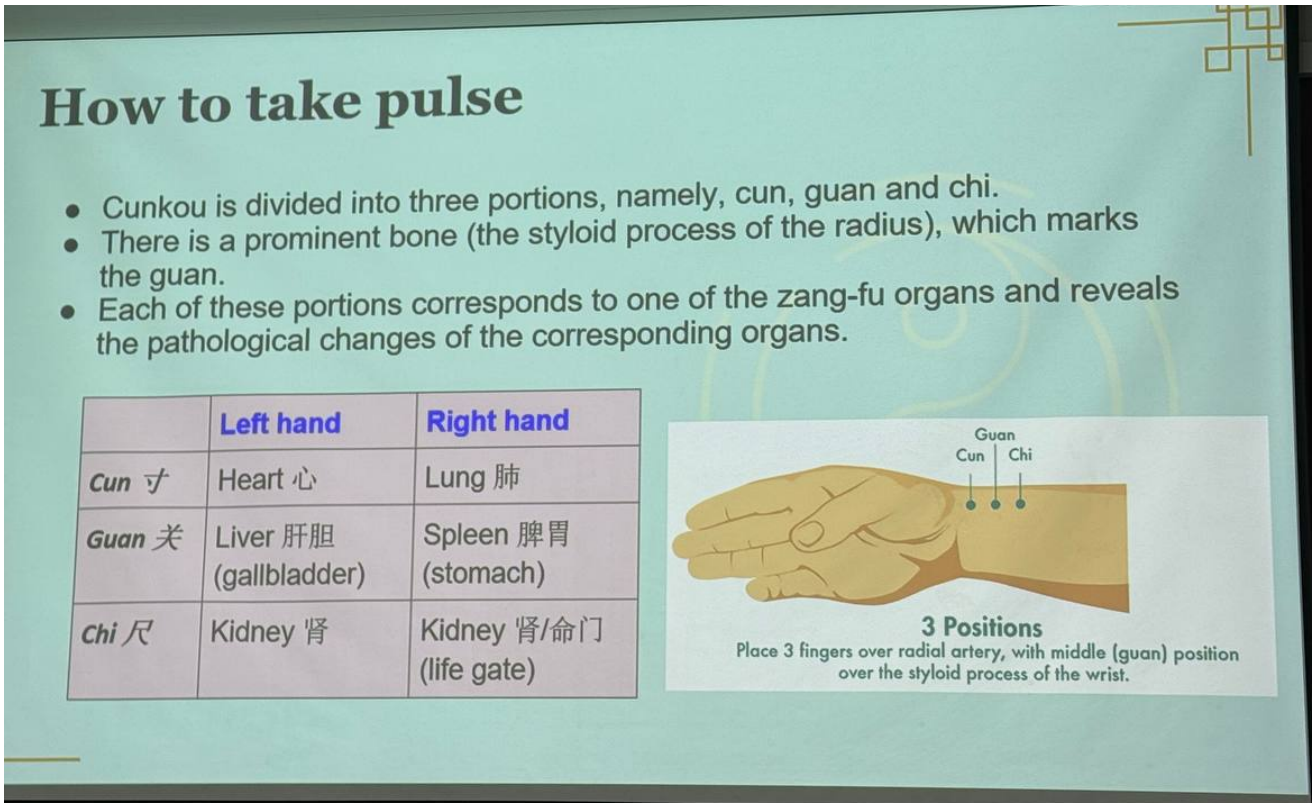


Figure 2. Three positions 寸、关、尺**.** The photographed slide combines the wrist diagram with left/right TCM organ correspondences.



Figure 3. Three pressure levels 浮、中、沉**.** Light, moderate and deeper pressure were used to assess pulse depth.

Sources: Cropped from photos ending 23-47-39 and 23-47-42. These illustrate the TCM assessment framework.

4. Chinese medicinal materials

Classification and five examples introduced in the slides.

The speaker identified **plant, animal and mineral** sources. “Chinese herbs” therefore includes more than plants. Students were invited to observe and smell the samples, but were explicitly told **not to taste them**.

Classification	Terms used in the session
Four natures 四气	Cold 寒, cool 凉, hot 热 and warm 温.
Five flavours 五味	Sour 酸, bitter 苦, salty 咸, pungent 辛 and sweet 甘.
Meridian affinity 归经	The TCM meridian or organ system that a medicinal material is understood to act on.
Function 功效	The traditional therapeutic action used to guide selection.

The five slide examples

Material and properties	Traditional functions / applications presented
Danggui 当归 Angelica sinensis Sweet, pungent, warm Liver, heart, spleen	Nourish blood, promote blood circulation, regulate menstruation, relieve pain and moisten the intestines. Examples: dizziness, palpitations, menstrual irregularities, injuries and constipation.
Huangqi 黄芪 Astragalus membranaceus Sweet, slightly warm Spleen, lung	Invigorate qi and strengthen exterior defence. Examples: fatigue, poor appetite, shortness of breath, sweating and loose stools.
Duzhong 杜仲 Eucommia ulmoides Sweet, warm Liver, kidney	Nourish liver/kidney and strengthen bones; the slide also gives a traditional pregnancy-support function. Examples include back/knee pain and frequent urination.
Meiguihua 玫瑰花 Rosa rugosa Sweet, slightly bitter, warm Liver, spleen	Promote qi circulation, relieve stress, harmonise blood and relieve pain. Examples: abdominal pain, menstrual irregularities and injuries.
Chantui 蝉蜕 Cicadae Periostracum Sweet, cold Lung, liver	Cicada moulting material: an animal-derived example. Slide functions include dispersing wind-heat, relieving itching, improving vision and relieving spasms; examples include rashes and eye discomfort.

Interpretation: these examples show how TCM links material properties, pattern assessment and treatment choice. They are not a ranked list of best-selling herbs or a record of actual prescriptions. Botanical names follow the slides.

Sources: Photos ending 23-47-48, 23-47-49, 23-47-49 (2), 23-47-50, 23-47-51 and 23-47-52; transcribe.txt 34:20-38:44. Only Danggui is reached before the supplied main transcript stops.

4A. Medicinal materials: images

Reference illustrations photographed from the five teaching slides.



Danggui 当归

Source slide: 23-47-49



Huangqi 黄芪

Source slide: 23-47-49 (2)



Duzhong 杜仲

Source slide: 23-47-50



Meiguihua 玫瑰花

Source slide: 23-47-51



Chantui 蝉蜕

Source slide: 23-47-52

Read alongside Section 4

The preceding table explains the traditional properties, meridian affinities and applications.

Illustrations are cropped from the visit slides, with the printed names retained.

Sources: Image areas cropped from the Danggui, Huangqi, Duzhong, Meiguihua and Chantui slides. Captions use the names printed on those slides.

5. Acupuncture and cupping

Acupuncture 针刺 and cupping 拔罐, documented by the later slide photographs.

Acupoints 穴位 introduced

Point	General location	Uses listed in the slide
DU20 Baihui 百会	Top of the head	Headache, dizziness, insomnia, tinnitus; dementia and stroke are also listed.
LI11 Quchi 曲池	Outer end of the elbow crease	Arm/elbow pain, heat, toothache and sore throat.
LI4 Hegu 合谷	Back of the hand, between first and second metacarpals	Heat, headache, toothache, eye and digestive issues.
ST36 Zusanli 足三里	Front/outer lower leg, below the knee	Bloating, diarrhoea and constipation; an immunity claim is also listed.
LIV3 Taichong 太冲	Top of the foot, near first and second metatarsals	Liver-qi stagnation patterns, including stress, irritability and menstrual irregularities.

Slide-label correction: Quchi appears as “LI21” in the photo; this is a likely slide typo for **LI11**. Locations above are descriptive summaries, not needling instructions.

Sensations and adverse effects discussed

The slide describes aching, numbness, distension and heaviness (酸麻胀重) as expected needling sensations. It also lists mild pain, bleeding or bruising after removal; nausea, dizziness or fainting; skin/allergic reactions; and infection. Fear of needles, hunger and insufficient rest were mentioned in relation to fainting. Sterile, single-use needles were highlighted.

Cupping 拔罐 methods

Method	Description in the slide
Stationary 留罐	Cups remain in place for about 10-15 minutes.
Flash 闪罐	Cups are applied and removed quickly and repeatedly over a broad area.
Moving / gliding 走罐	Cups move along meridians for about 5-10 minutes.

The slide presents cupping as helping pain/inflammation, muscle tightness, blood flow and range of movement. A separate colour chart assigns TCM labels to marks, including stagnation and dampness. Record these as **claims shown in teaching**; the chart does not itself demonstrate that mark colour measures toxins or internal disease.

Sources: Photos ending 23-47-53, 23-47-54, 23-47-55 and 23-47-55 (2). The cupping colour chart carries Thomson branding, so its exact wording should not be attributed as an original Thong Chai statement.

5A. Treatment: photo references

Acupoint illustrations and the three cupping methods shown during teaching.

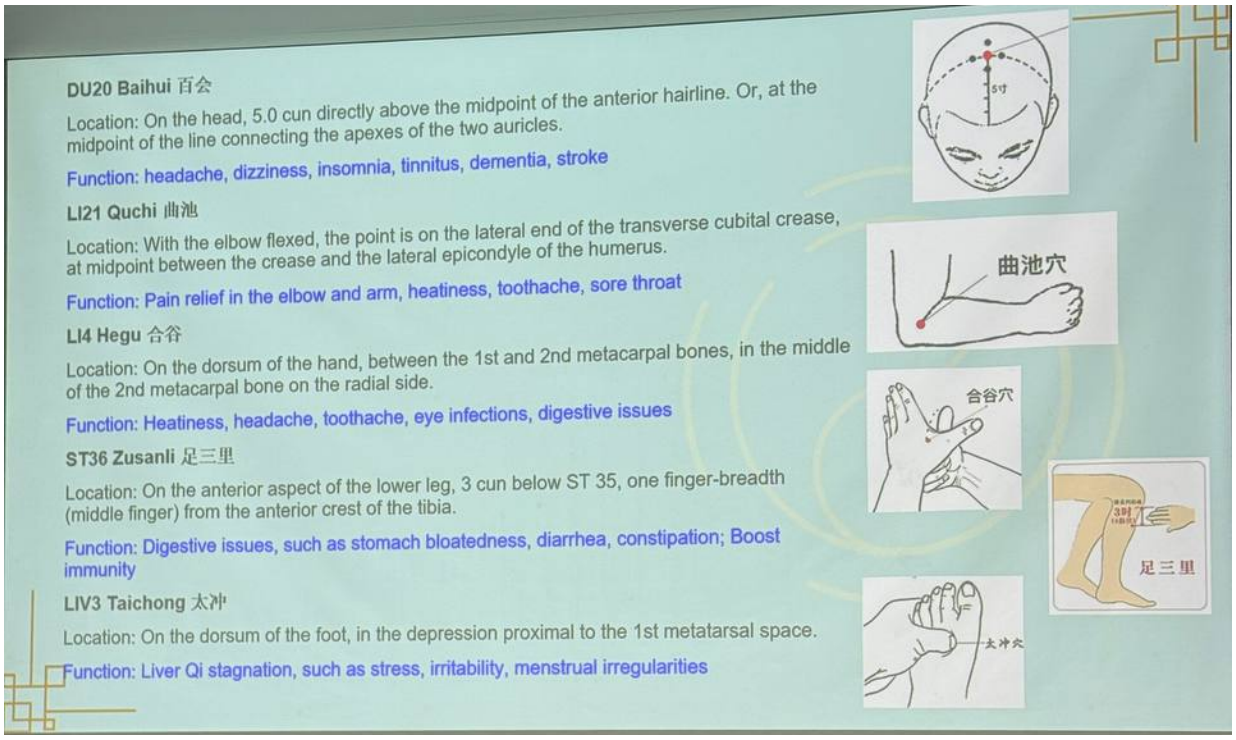


Figure 4. Acupoints 穴位**.** The five illustrated points match Section 5. The original slide prints Quchi as LI21; the notes flag the likely correction to LI11.

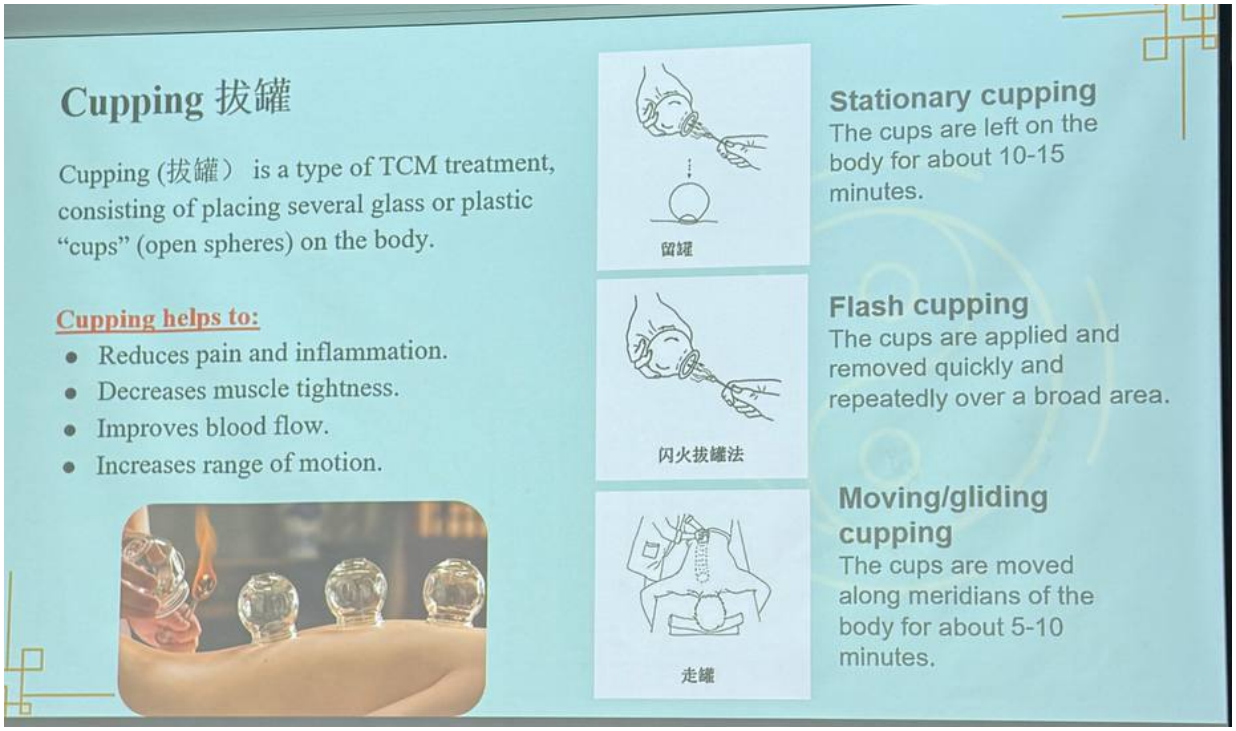


Figure 5. Cupping 拔罐**.** Stationary 留罐, flash 闪罐 and moving/gliding 走罐 methods. The original benefit statements are presented as teaching claims.

Sources: Cropped from photos ending 23-47-54 and 23-47-55. These are descriptive visit references, not instructions for self-treatment.

6. Using the visit in your report

Keep observations, interpretation and missing evidence separate.

Three strong report themes

Theme	Evidence from the visit	Reasonable interpretation
Accessible, inclusive care	The speaker described free care regardless of race, religion or nationality.	TCM can function as a community resource extending across ethnic and religious boundaries. This illustrates an inclusive intention, not measured social outcomes.
Individualised assessment	Tongue and pulse demonstrations; the speaker said the same disease may receive different treatments.	The visit illustrates pattern differentiation and the role of practitioner judgement in tailoring care.
Stress within TCM theory	Stress/anger linked to wiry pulse; Meiguihua described as relieving stress; LIV3 linked with stress/irritability.	The teaching connects emotional experience with bodily patterns. It does not establish diagnosis or effective treatment of clinical anxiety or depression.

Claims to exclude or qualify

The extra file **txt1.txt** contains earlier commentary and suggested report prose. It is secondary material, not a verified transcript. The supplied primary material does **not** establish that damp heat is the most common pattern among Singaporean youth, that Thong Chai follows a specific local “Qing Bu” policy, or that the speaker described a mental-health referral policy.

The slides separately map the left guan position to liver/gallbladder and link stress with wiry pulse. They do not show that stress must produce a wiry pulse **specifically at left guan**. Avoid combining these statements into a stronger claim.

What remains missing

No confirmed visit date, speaker name, actual patient records or treatment outcomes are supplied. There is no sales ranking, locally produced product list, soup-therapy ranking, least-used product list or prescribing-frequency dataset. These materials cannot fill those survey requirements without additional evidence.

Source and coverage guide

Main transcript: transcribe.txt, duplicated verbatim in “# Singapore Thong Chai Medical Inst.txt”. The main transcript reaches 38:44 of a stated 1:14:02 recording. Its backup excerpt reaches 07:21 and overlaps the same session; the two are not independent interviews. Timestamps used here follow the main transcript.

Photographs: 21 files named photo_2026-10-15_23-47-36.jpg through photo_2026-10-15_23-47-55.jpg, including (2) versions at 49 and 55. Photo suffixes in each source note identify the original files.

Coverage: this document summarises the supplied photos and existing transcription. The included audio has not been newly transcribed or independently checked. Health-related statements are reported as session content, not clinical recommendations.